

Speaker 1: So, before we start, how would you like us to name your partner?

Speaker 2: I wasn't expecting that question! Whatever, really! (laughs)

Speaker 1: It can be partner, boyfriend, I don't know, whatever you prefer.

Speaker 2: You can say my boyfriend, that way I'm sure to answer that.

Speaker 1: Great, let's do that. And how long have you been with your boyfriend then?

Speaker 2 : It's going to be... It's going to be... Excuse me, really! It's been [6-10] years. We've known each other longer, that's why I've been thinking. I think it should be [6-10] years.

Speaker 1: To begin with, I'd like you to tell me a little about your love story with him. How did it happen? How did you meet?

Speaker 2: The first time we met was in high school. And back then, we'd never have gone out together. We got on really well, no worries (laughs). I don't think we were mature enough, him or me. And then, over the years, we got a lot closer and became best friends. We saw each other as a couple. And one day, we were both single. One day, we were with each other, at home, in my apartment. I was lying with my head on his stomach. We both felt that something extra had been created. One day, we kissed and said to each other... Maybe we like each other. That was about it.

Speaker 1: From what you've told me, I get the impression that it was almost a little unexpected as a development? Or would you say you were expecting it?

Speaker 2: For me, it was unexpected. It wasn't something we'd thought about, it wasn't even something I'd imagined. I hadn't said to myself one day, why not? It could have been a possibility, when you say to yourself with such and such a friend, we could go out. It wasn't even a thought that occurred to me at the time.

Speaker 1: And how do you explain this change of direction?

Speaker 2: I deeply believe that there comes a point when you're ready, and so is the other person, that you need to go through stages, and that it was the right time, and that the feelings had been created along the way, and we weren't necessarily aware of it at the time, and that it changes a little bit from start to finish. And I think that because we understood each other so well, the love was born out of the deep friendship we already had together, and because there was also the possibility that, basically, we weren't in a relationship, there was nothing committing us to anyone, the feelings might have developed more easily. But that's just my hypothesis, I have no idea if it's true or not. But sometimes there's a moment, there's a moment that's the right moment.

Speaker 1 : You mentioned a deep friendship, could you describe it a little?

Speaker 2 : Meaning?

Speaker 1: At the time, how did you feel it was a deep friendship?

Speaker 2: We could talk about anything, there were no taboos, there are a lot of taboos sometimes in friendships, there are subjects we don't dare broach. And with him, we always talked about everything, whether it was our sexuality or our relationships. In other words, we pushed each other, which meant that when we felt things were getting out of hand, we were there to give them a little push (?), to say, you're exaggerating a little. But at the same time, we could confide in each other, say things, and there were never any worries in that respect. At least I never felt that way about him, but I always knew that I could confide in him and that things would stay between us. I wasn't judged, I knew that that it wouldn't come back to me one day. We could trust each other and yet, despite everything, we were very different, there were things we didn't necessarily have in common. But we respected each other for who we were.

Speaker 1: You're saying that there were things that you two didn't have in common at all?

Speaker 2: Yes.

Speaker 1: Like what, for example?

Speaker 2: Back then, I'm someone who likes to work well in advance, whereas he's very last-minute at the (?), where I can be quite stressed, he's not, he's quite calm about it. I'm a very organized person in that respect, whereas he was much more of a spendthrift back in the day. There were things where, deep down, we could have disagreed on certain aspects.

Speaker 1: So, since you started out as a couple, how has your relationship gone? How has it developed?

Speaker 2: Very quickly, very naturally. At first, we kept it to ourselves. We figured you never know, as they say: mutual friendship means mutual friends. We got together very quickly, and then very quickly moved in together. It wasn't a long time, less than a year, it all happened really quickly.

Speaker 1 : Really?

Speaker 2: Yes, that's what I was saying. At first, we said no, we'd have to take it easy, each of us having our own apartment and all that. Then, when we realized that we'd been living in each other's apartments for [1-5] months, we thought, well, it's much nicer to have just one apartment, let's be logical. So we got something together. And then, we've travelled a lot, we have our common hopes that we've been able to put together and everything.

Speaker 1: How have things been since you've been living together?

Speaker 2: It's going well. There was a period at the beginning when it was more difficult to get our spaces to coexist. But in fact, we discuss everything. So when something doesn't fit or there's a need, it's very easy to adapt. And then, no, cohabitation goes well, because we know how to give each other our space when we need it. We have our cues.

Speaker 1: Did you say you had signs?

Speaker 2: Yes. Basically, literally, for me it's... I need my own time and don't... No, but really, I don't want to see anyone. And or I don't mind you being there, but don't talk to me, don't... Just your presence. And he'll tell me, right now, I'm in cave mode. When I'm better, I'll tell you. Anyway, we've got the code, the door's ajar, so you can come in and all that. Or he'll come out and see me. And I know that at that point, he doesn't really need his own time. And we can talk again, interact without any worries, without... Very bad idea to interact at this point. We haven't... We've already had the experience of seeing what happens then. We're less... Less patient. We really need this time and space.

Speaker 1: Okay. And if you had to compare your relationship with your boyfriend with the relationships you see with your friends, for example, how they are in a relationship, what would you say?

Speaker 2: They're totally separate. Without (?) for my friends, I'm saying to myself oh poor people! No, it's nothing like them. It's just that I think our past relationships with each other made us realize all the things we didn't want in a couple. And now, with our friends, we find that we like our way of being because there's communication, we respect each other, there's no sexism in tasks or things like that. It's not help, in fact. We're partners, we're two in a room. The apartment is both of ours. The apartment has to be managed by both of us. After that, we distribute tasks or things like that. But no, vis à vis, our friends, it's really very different. In fact, I think it suits us, and even reassures us in a way by saying no, it's fine as it is. There's no envy. And even apart from friends, even family, if we compare couples, our parents, who are still in couples a bit... No, it's not like that either.

Speaker 1: I think there's a bit of a bug. Can you hear me? No ? Ah, hello! I'm back again.

Speaker 2 : Okay, I'm getting two screens, is that normal?

Speaker 1 : Yes, what's the other one?

Speaker 2 : You in frozen version.

Speaker 1 : Ah, can't you see me?

Speaker 2: A frozen version, an unfrozen version.

Speaker 1: Okay, well, we'll keep it that way. I'm the two, but I don't know, there's one coming from somewhere else.

Speaker 2: I can pull it off to the side, so that's fine.

Speaker 1: Yes, sorry, but you were telling me that your relationship is more of a partnership, there's not too much imbalance in who does what, as I had the impression you might observe in other couples.

Speaker 2: Yes, or a lack of... Especially a lack of communication. When we talk to our friends, we realize what makes it hard for couples to stay together. That it's precisely this lack of communication. Basically, they don't say things to each other, I think for fear of hurting someone's feelings. But in fact, the longer you wait, the worse it gets. Afterwards, the other person can't understand, and then all of a sudden they're criticized for something they've been doing for [1-5] years. I think it can be brutal for the other person too. So yes, for me, there's a big difference. If I had to make a comparison, I'd say we're pretty close, even if we're totally different, but we have some of the same values as a couple.

Speaker 1: So it's communication that's constant, it's not only when there's a conflict that people start talking, if I understand correctly.

Speaker 2: Yes, that's it. We really try to discuss things before a conflict arises. When we talk about a subject, we don't assume that the other person will have the same point of view. We work on the principle that anything is possible. You can agree or disagree. And that it's okay.

Speaker 1: And now, if you had to compare your relationship to relationships you may have had in the past, if any, what would you say about it?

Speaker 2: That I've learned a lot, that I wouldn't make the same mistakes, I might make others, but I wouldn't make the same mistakes, and that in each of my relationships, there are no regrets, because I think that's what makes me the person I am today, and that without that, I'd never have been able to evolve to be in the relationship I am in today. And I think that's cool. It doesn't matter how it ended, because some of them were more or less epic, but deep down, I tell myself that these relationships built me up. Those were real times.

Speaker 1: You say that it built you up. What did you learn from these relationships?

Speaker 2: Some of them gave me self-confidence, the courage to say no. Knowing oneself, loving oneself, feeling loved, it's little things like that, where having self-confidence doesn't necessarily depend on how the other person looks at you, and living for yourself, and not for the other person, that in a couple, you're not two, you're one first of all, and then afterwards, you're two. And I think that in my past relationships, we were two before we were one. And I think that in the end, we forget each other, and that can only be negative in the long term, at some point, we fade away. And I think that's something I've learned as I've gone along, that I've said things that I didn't necessarily mean, so as not to hurt the other person's feelings, little things like that. And in the end, you hurt everyone's feelings. So I'd say that would be it.

Speaker 1: So it's the idea that... I mean, if there's a notion of independence a little bit, but you remain yourself in the relationship, it's not the relationship that encompasses everything, is it?

Speaker 2: Yeah, it's not the relationship that defines me. It's the opposite, each of us will define the relationship, but it's not the other way around.

Speaker 1: And you've told me that sometimes you feel like you're fading into the background in your relationship.

Speaker 2: Yeah. Er... Erase in the... I think I was erasing myself, but I was reproducing the same patterns I'd seen in my parents or whatever. Basically, the way I behaved, I was acting as if by mimicry, I think, without even realizing it, I was just doing it the same way. And I realize that it's not... It's not something that... In fact, you fall into it and you don't even realize it. It just happens.

Speaker 1: So is it... I mean, acting like, it's reproducing patterns you've observed in relationships around you, is that it or is it something else?

Speaker 2 : Meaning? I'm not sure I understood the question.

Speaker 1: Oh yes, you were telling me that you acted like what you'd seen, right? And so, it's like the relationships we were talking about earlier, isn't it?

Speaker 2: Uh... Yes and no. I think there's a part of you that's just the way you are. It's just that we're building ourselves up, we don't know what we want yet, and it's a bit like crazy love, and we can't see anything other than what we want. But at the same time, there's an element of mimicry. You reproduce a little bit, you look for the same things without doing it on purpose, or you reproduce exactly the same thing without even thinking about it. We just think that's the way it is. But you don't feel like you're doing the same thing. We say to ourselves, no, never. Looking back now on the relationships I've had, I say to myself, well, yes. At the time, no. But afterwards, yes. But afterwards, yes. You think, yeah, it's easy to do exactly the same thing again. It's familiar, it's reassuring.

Speaker 1: You say it's reassuring to do what you know?

Speaker 2: Yes, because we know roughly what it can lead to. Just about.

Speaker 1: And so, if I understand correctly, in your relationship now, do you feel there's less of this notion of doing what you know, or is it still there?

Speaker 2: I think it's always there. It's a bit like the education our parents gave us. We detach ourselves from them, but deep down, they're still the ones who raised us, whether we agree with them or not. But for me, couples are a bit like that. We stick to what we see. So even if we detach ourselves from it, there are still things that remain the same.

Speaker 1: I'd like you to tell me what a high-quality relationship would be like for you.

Speaker 2: High quality? It wouldn't be people who agree on everything. Deeply. I think it's precisely because we're different. I think they're two different people, but with deep values in common. Who exchange, who discuss, who accept that sometimes the other may fail, may not succeed in expressing himself. In a couple where there are bound to be arguments, I think that a couple who tells me there are no arguments, I find that (?). At least no conflicts. There's no moment where it's too weird, it's too smooth. There's something wrong. And supportive. Where you support one another, a lot. There's love, but for me love is something to be nurtured. It's not something you have and never lose. Because you can always have affection for someone, but love is something else. There really is a difference. And I think if there's all that, it's still an ideal relationship. Basically, support, communication, love, not taking each other for granted. Everything can change anyway. One doesn't prevent the other, and that's normal.

Speaker 1: And how do you know when you're in a relationship where there's this support?

Speaker 2: I think the future and the trials will show you anyway at some point. In any case, it will be through adversity, through obstacles. That's when you see whether the other person will be there for you. Or is it that as soon as there's a conflict, a problem, they'll cast off, jump ship and leave you in the lurch? I think it's adversity. In any case, there's bound to be adversity at some point. Big or small, but there are bound to be signs at some point.

Speaker 1: When would you say your current relationship has been most supportive?

Speaker 2: The moment when we were most supportive of each other?

Speaker 1: Yes, that's right. You had the impression that it was a supportive relationship.

Speaker 2: Wedding preparations. It really puts a couple to the test. Like I said. Honestly, if you don't get over it, you won't make it to the big day. I said it straight out. I think that was the best proof. There's no doubt about it.

Speaker 1: So, that was your test of adversity.

Speaker 2: Yeah, because confronting our families, two different families, is the best proof of adversity there is. Because they're the people you're most connected to, normally. It depends on each person. And who has the most impact on us. And if you can stand up to your parents when you're a couple, that's a great sign of support. Support, yes, I think.

Speaker 1: So, support means supporting each other in the face of...

Speaker 2: Don't give up on the other person. For example, when you're not doing well. Because, in fact, it happened to me. I had a moment of depression. I don't know if you can characterize it like that, but I think... Just because there was no diagnosis doesn't mean... But really, I wasn't well. And the fact that the person is there every day to help you, to accompany you, to be there for you, not to let you down at any time, I think you can say that it's someone who won't let you down later.

Speaker 1: On the contrary, were there times when you felt you were the least... in your current relationship, when it was less supportive, for example?

Speaker 2 : Yes, of course. We've looked at each other and said... What do we do with each other sometimes? But it's more of a passing thing. I don't know, more like a short moment, but it's happened.

Speaker 1: And you also told me that a high-quality relationship is one where there's communication. Well, we've already talked about it a bit, but how can we know when we're in a relationship where there's this communication present?

Speaker 2: It's a number of things. There's already being face to face with the other person and knowing what they need, whether we're actively listening and participating, or whether they just need to vent. In other words, there are times when there are things that can be discussed and things that can't be discussed. It doesn't have to be that way. And so, you have to be attentive to the other person and step out of your own needs a little and tell yourself that I'm making myself available to him because he really needs it. And then, in communication, for example during an exchange, which isn't just in cases where the person just needs to perhaps relax a little from their week, things they're not doing or things that are irritating them, it's also about knowing when, when we're talking, to also read behind the lines. There's what the person says, what the person implies. And sometimes, there's a difference between what the person is asking for and what the person needs. And that's where good communication comes in. Because people often say, "Yes, I've answered his request". But you haven't met his need. In fact, yes, that was his request. But there was something else behind it. And sometimes, we're aware of it. Still, it's okay to screw up, that's not a problem. To really put yourself in the other person's shoes at that moment, and to say to yourself what they needed or wanted to hear, without forgetting yourself behind it. In other words, it's always a game of... a bit like a little gauge that moves. And from time to time, the other is more present, the other communicates more, the other is more attentive. And then, seize the right moments to talk about it too. Find the right moments to communicate. There are always plenty available.

Speaker 1: What would be a good time to communicate?

Speaker 2: When the person is calm. Sometimes, discussion comes on its own. You start talking about one thing, then another. And then, finally, you come to a subject, and then you talk deeply about that subject. You go further. You say to yourself, "Ah, you, what would you have done?" "What would your point of view have been if you had to choose?" "Here, let's imagine, you have a child or you have a.... What would you do?" "But what's your point of view?" "Are you for or against this subject?" And then, there you go, just knowing the person's point of view, their thinking, their way of seeing things.

Speaker 1: And conversely, a bad time?

Speaker 2: Back from work. When I get home from work, I think it's a bad idea. Very early in the morning, when you get up, you have to let the person emerge too. At a time when you're not

hungry either. It sounds silly, but... It's better to eat before talking. Personally, I prefer to eat before talking. I'm not very available if I haven't eaten... For me, it's outside all those moments. You don't make a decision when you haven't eaten, when you haven't slept well, when you've just had a hard day. At that point, it's just a matter of listening. In other words, the person lets go of their day a little, but it's not a discussion as such. It's really... It's something else. It's a release.

Speaker 1: It's a time when you're both physically ready - you've slept well, eaten well - and mentally ready - you're ready to tackle the thing, you're not tired from the day's work.

Speaker 2: If we're full, we're in blackout mode or something. Nobody's patient at that point, to be honest. You're hungry, you're bitter. You just have to see it during the day, in relationships, other than romantic ones, with colleagues, or things like that. If you've been listening to your stomach singing for an hour, you generally don't feel like making a decision, you don't feel like listening to someone talk to you for half an hour, you're just thinking about your meal that's about to heat up in the microwave. And after that, you're available.

Speaker 1: And when would you say your relationship with your boyfriend was most about communication?

Speaker 2: I didn't hear. Some words got jumbled.

Speaker 1: At what point do you feel your current relationship has been most about communication?

Speaker 2: No idea. I'd say all the time and never at the same time. It's just... It's moments. I wouldn't have a specific moment in mind. Where I'd say to myself, ah we've communicated well and all that. It's more like when we have a conflict, when we start arguing, and in the end, we're able to understand each other deeply and we've both taken a step back and we're able to communicate again. I find that it requires so much personal effort that I say to myself that, basically, in terms of communication, we can value it so, so, so much.

Speaker 1: I understand. On the other hand, were there times when you had the impression that communication was a little off or not going so well?

Speaker 2: Yes. Often, it's very silly things. It's the moment when I think there are words we haven't heard, definitions of words we don't share and which block or hurt the other or put the other off and by the time we've got it out, communication's long gone. I often think that's pretty good. You can tell there's a break. It doesn't matter what's said, it's over anyway.

Speaker 1: You said definitions of words that aren't the same? Like what, for example?

Speaker 2: I wouldn't have an example in mind, because we're not the kind of people who keep things and then say, "There's such and such". But I know it's happened to us before, because when we're getting in each other's heads, what do you mean by so much? And when the other one explained it, we went, ah but no, but in fact, not at all, that's not at all what I meant. No, no, yes, I understand if you take it the wrong way, but no, that's not what I meant at all. I just know

that at that moment, it's really the, "ah, but no". I mean, it wasn't the intention at all. It depends on what anyone can help me say, but sometimes it can be adjectives instead. If I had to give a direction, it's adjectives or things like that that are perceived negatively or positively by the other person.

Speaker 1: Right. Yes, so it's, you each see the word in a slightly different way and that's what causes a bit of friction in communication.

Speaker 2: Yes, that's it, and at that point, it's over, because in fact, the other person feels literally attacked, because he's literally, it's as if he's being called an asshole, literally, that's it. And in fact, in your head, you say, ah, I hadn't seen things like that, it's not exactly the will, it wasn't the aim. But the person took it as it was. Why did he do it? We don't know, but that's how they perceive it in any case.

Speaker 1: Yes, everyone brings their own language baggage and so on.

Speaker 2: Yes, it's often more this that blocks communication, generally. Yes, I might have an example, so it's not the most blatant, but it's like saying to someone, "yeah, but you've never done that". The word never. For me, it's an obstacle to communication, because in fact, when you say never, it's impossible for it to be never. There's bound to be a moment, maybe, and for me it blocks communication. It's a way of talking, often people say, yeah, but you've never done it to me. Yes, the person did it to you once, but maybe it was a long time ago. Sometimes we tend to overuse phrases, and that can quickly get the other person thinking, yeah, maybe I haven't done that here, but never! Sometimes it's hard to swallow. We don't listen to the rest of the sentence, we just pick up on the word that's bothering us.

Speaker 1: Yes, it's a strong word, after all.

Speaker 2: That's it. But it happened with words that were a little different, where really, there was a definition that wasn't at all the same, that we didn't perceive in the same way.

Speaker 1: And so, we've seen that a good quality relationship would be one where there's communication, support, a poor quality relationship, what would define it, then?

Speaker 2: I think it would be of poor quality from the moment one or the other suffers from it. When it's deeply wrong, in fact. When the other says it doesn't suit them, and you see real suffering, for me, there's a problem. Every couple is different, and I don't think there's such a thing as a perfect couple. There's no such thing as a perfect relationship, because everyone has their own definition of the relationship that suits them. But as soon as one or the other suffers, for me it's a bad relationship. There's no debate for me at that point. It's because there's a fundamental problem. That would be it. The suffering in it. That love is closer to hate at some point. That that boundary, it's a fine line.

Speaker 1: Where there's more... I mean... a relationship where there's a bit of an imbalance, where it's more likely to cause suffering than to bring something to the table.

Speaker 2: Yeah, for me, the relationship has to bring something to the table. If it doesn't, it almost becomes... It's pretty placid. And just below that, in fact, it's... well... It's kind of the phrase, what do you guys do together, really? If roommates, it's pretty much the same thing. You're not far from ignorance. And then some, we're really talking about hate. I mean, you can feel it, it's... It's virulent. For me, that's where the relationship is bad. That's when it suffers. And even if you love someone deeply, you can make them suffer enormously, I think. It's not necessarily always about love.

Speaker 1: You're saying it's not always about love?

Speaker 2: I think it's possible to be in a good relationship and no longer feel... Some people don't feel love anymore, just affection. After that, everyone calls their relationship what they want. But a bad relationship can be a place where they love each other deeply. But if they haven't found their balance, for me, it's a bad relationship. Because if they're suffering from it, they're going to say, "Yeah, but I love her, but... I love her, but..." That's the I love him, but... And it's the but that's sometimes a little too... It encroaches a little too much on the love side. In other words, it's a bit like first that and then I love her anyway. And yeah, for me, that would be... Well, that's my point of view, but... For me, it would be a bad relationship.

Speaker 1: Have you ever felt, in a relationship, this question of... of suffering, finally, and not getting much out of it?

Speaker 2: Yes, I would say my last relationship. Before this one. I think at some point, you split in one direction without meaning to. And there's more... We loved each other, but that was the end of it, really. It was already... Already too impacted. At some point... It was more complicated. I think there came a point when both he and I could no longer find a way out. But I don't think it was a lack of love.

Speaker 1: So, we've talked about the things that are important to you. Are there any other things that come to mind as being very important in a love relationship?

Speaker 2: Respect. I'm looking for a word. It's on the tip of my tongue, but I can't find it. Yeah, respect... Respect, benevolence. It's also a little close to consent. But the three are going to connect a little bit anyway, a lot.

Speaker 1: How do you perceive respect in a relationship?

Speaker 2: It's as much in our words as in our actions. I think it's a mixture. And respect isn't just respect for others, it's also respect for yourself. It's a lot of little things in everyday life. I don't know how to explain it. It would be... It means respecting other people's speech and freedom. It's respecting their values, it's respecting... their wishes, their desires. It's a lot of things. It's... without (?) your own. Respect for others stops where yours begins. There's a boundary, though. It's a set of things.

Speaker 1: It's a multi-dimensional concept.

Speaker 2 : To define it would be to reduce it.

Speaker 1: We've already talked about love, but drawing on your own experience, what does love really mean to you?

Speaker 1: I think it depends towards who. It depends on what you call love. Is it just love relationships or the love you have for a friend or something? Do you feel love? But... I don't think it can be explained. It's something that's there. You love someone because you love them. There's no reason for it. And when that love, I don't know, it's a feeling of well-being. But I can't explain it. You love someone because you love them. There's no valid reason. There's no particular motive. You love someone because you love them. It's about you. It's a connection. It's a relationship. It's a relationship. It's a connection you have with that person. In love, I think you go through several types of love. There's one where you think things are simple. And when love is simple, I find it much more... There's nothing else behind it. It's just love. I don't say to myself, "Oh, this is crazy love! I love it! I couldn't live my life without him!" We're not about that at all. We're really about I love him because I love him. I don't love him very much, I love him. That's all there is to it. That's kind of the definition.

Speaker 1: How important is love to you in your relationship?

Speaker 2: For me, it's what makes our relationship. It's what made us end up going out with each other. It's something that doesn't last forever. It's like a fire, it feeds on itself. I don't know if it's eternal or not. I have mixed feelings about it. It's just the way it is. I still think it's an essential bare minimum, even if it's going to change shape over the years. I don't feel the same love for him that I did at the beginning of our relationship as I do now. It's changed. It's not better, it's not bigger, it's not worse, it's different. But it's still there for me. It has a place, it's the foundation. It's the foundation.

Speaker 1: You say it's a love that has transformed over the course of the relationship. How did it transform?

Speaker 2: At first, it's all pretty and pink. You experience it, quote, just by looking at it. As time goes by, you see the flaws. Then you reposition this love. There's a little bit of everything. But even if the way we grow up is different, deep down, love remains the same. There's always that same base. It's the same thing as when you look at yourself for the first time and say "I don't regret it". It's evolved. We don't have the same proof of affection. We don't need to be as attached to each other as we were at the very beginning of our relationship. At the very beginning, we did a lot of things together. Now, that doesn't mean we love each other any less. The love is just expressed differently. Through different attentions, through different ways of expressing it verbally to each other.

Speaker 1: Precisely, we know that there are different ways of expressing love. In your relationship, how do you know your boyfriend loves you? How does he show it?

Speaker 2: Attentions. I'm very sensitive to the effort he puts in. I'm not very sensitive to gifts. He clearly knows that. I'm not very sensitive to the value of the gift itself. But I'm more sensitive to

the effort that went into it. To have taken the time to. I'm sensitive to the recognition. All that tells me how much he loves me. I know it makes me feel valued at that moment.

Speaker 1: I'd like you to tell me about one of the last positive interactions you had with your boyfriend.

Speaker 2: This morning. I wasn't feeling well. He made me my little hot water bottle. He made me breakfast in bed. He really knows how to calm me down. He prepared me in advance. By the way, the e-mail you received with the consent letter was filled in by him and sent to me. Thanks to him. He told me I hadn't had time. He anticipated my needs. That was the last... The last thing we did together recently. For me, it's a positive interaction.

Speaker 1: And then, actually, it comes back to what you've just told me about paying attention to others, the effort to pay attention to others.

Speaker 2: Yes, that's it. But it's not the same for him. It's different for him.

Speaker 1: Could you also tell me about a last negative interaction you had with him, if any?

Speaker 2:... I know there's been some recently, but I wouldn't be able to describe it like that. Yes, without... When we get into it, actually. When we're banging our heads together, when we can't understand each other. ... For me, it's negative from the moment I get angry. The moment I get pissed. I say it's negative because in the end, you raise your voice, you're pissed off, and you say fuck it. ... We started talking, it was 1pm, it's 3pm, we're still going at it. Time flies when you're arguing ... So that would be negative interaction. Yes, I couldn't even say why, it's so stupid.

Speaker 1: Okay, and could you tell me about any challenges you think there might be in your relationship?

Speaker 2:... Coming to an agreement about what's next, about the future, for example, moving out, leaving again. That would be all the big moments, agreeing on... How we want to live, what we see for the future, do we see ourselves... ... Why not a child, more? It's going to be a challenge to find support, a place for each other, how we see each other, and what we want. Trying to get both our desires to coexist, without one of them being the echo. I think that's the challenge we still have to face, as long as we don't take each other for granted. We just have to keep doing what we're doing. But yes, the hardest thing is to position yourself. For me, the hardest part is managing to stand up to our families, our parents, to behave like adults, to let our voice be heard and not let ourselves be imposed on or impacted by those we love, too. ... In spite of everything.

Speaker 1: We know that not everything in a relationship is rosy. Could you tell me about any conflicts or arguments you've had with your boyfriend?

Speaker 2 :... Um... Our type of argument is often when we can't agree on how to do things. Basically, I'll take a silly example, but we've tidied up one way, and you've got the other one tidying up the other way. ... It comes across as me having tidied badly. That's it, it causes conflicts, more... ... agreements or... ... Anything that might be... ...financial management, purchasing, bigger

things, impactful stuff. ... Yeah, that kind of thing that... Otherwise, afterwards, it's just... stupidity, it's just venting, basically, this argument, not for the real reason. Basically, we just wanted to have a go at each other, and then, it's fine! ...

Speaker 1: And how often would you say these arguments happen? For example, over two weeks, does it happen... Well, I don't know how often.

Speaker 2: Yeah, at least once every [1-5] weeks, you need at least a little time off. If it hasn't happened all week, we know it's coming up for the second. Usually, there's a premise at some point. Yeah, in the course of [1-5] month, it happens twice, though, easy. At least!

Speaker 1: And how do you... What happens afterwards?

Speaker 2: So... We can either solve the problem directly. And if we solve it directly, there are two possibilities. Either we walk away from each other, and come back 5, 10, an hour later. ... Or we can spend a positive moment together, directly, and do something more relaxing. Or we really get into it, and... at some point, yeah, we... we stop talking for a while, until we're ready 3, 4, 5, 6 hours later to talk! Or not! Sometimes, we'll just say that we agree, that we... that we disagree. Well, that we couldn't agree, yeah. Do we talk about it? And there's a bit of the... If one of us needs to talk about it again, we'll talk about it again. If there's no need, we say okay... Forget it! And we move on, that's it. That's... It's pretty... There's always more or less the same type of argument.

Speaker 1: And... How do you maintain your relationship with each other?

Speaker 2: Different from each other. For me, maintaining it means valuing him. Well, there's a lot of valorization. I know it's important. I don't want anything, just to tell him that I'm proud of him, that he's really managing, that there's nothing to worry about. I trust him completely. And... His belly. Literally, if I cook for him, he's happy. The intention is to make him a little something, something he likes, something he loves. Something that'll make him go wild. Little surprises. A little note left on the table. There you go. To tell him to have a good day. That's what it's going to be like for me, towards him. That's what's going to sustain us.

Speaker 1: You told me that there are ways... I mean, that your two ways of nurturing are different. What's his?

Speaker 2: Uh... His, towards me?

Speaker 1 : Yes.

Speaker 2: Well, if he cooks for me, well! It's not going to change much. Er... No, what I said was that, as with attention and love, it brings (us?) closer together. Basically, it's being there, supporting, listening. It's... It's a little less about the kind words. It's more about support. It's not exactly the same thing for me. Then, yeah, the attentions. In other words, a little word or something like that too, which means we'll both get closer on the... The way we are.

Speaker 1: I'd also like to know what might make you leave your partner.

Speaker 2: Um... If we can no longer understand each other. That is, at some point, we reach an dead-end. If the relationship he's in makes him suffer. I'd tell him that I'd prefer him to be happy with someone else, even if I'm committed to the relationship, that I'd prefer him to stay. If he's unhappy, I'd rather he left. And cheating. There you go. There's no debate here, alcohol, no alcohol, whatever. Deception, there's no... There's no negotiating that. It's... For me, it's a brake, because it's also trust. I know I wouldn't be... Deep down, it'll always be in the back of my mind. But yeah, betrayal, that would be... It would end the relationship.

Speaker 1: Okay. Would you say that this relationship is good for you?

Speaker 2: I'd say so. Right now. Because it pushes me to be the best version of myself. And we're loooooong way from the goal. But yes, it's... Yes. I have no doubt about that right now.

Speaker 1: You say it pushes you to be the best version of yourself?

Speaker 2: Yes, because he's got a mouth on him. And... Because of our friendship, perhaps. If he... He's not going to tell me things just to please me. If I'm not doing well, and he knows I can do better, and he'll push me, he'll make sure I make it. He'll tell me you can, in fact. Now you're just kidding, go ahead, you can. And even regarding him, he pushes himself that far. I want to support him. Like how I want him to be for me. And I want to push him like he pushes me. And that it also pushes me to do things on my own, telling myself that we're not going to just hang around. So there you go. We can go further, we can improve. You can always do things differently.

Speaker 1: It's sometimes said that being in a good relationship means, for example, helping each other achieve goals, or that there's a certain notion of regulating emotions on a daily basis. Is that something you find in your relationship?

Speaker 2: Yes, on both counts. I think we calm each other down on certain aspects. Precisely because we're different. Where I need him, he's there. And where he needs it, I'm more of a support to him than he is to me in the same respect. And I think that's a good thing, because it also helps to soften certain character traits. Which are sometimes more or less dominant. Thanks to that, it calms us down.

Speaker 1: Do you have an example of a situation in which you managed to appease either him, you, or you, him?

Speaker 2: For me, it would be anything to do with anger. I can express it and it's less... Voluminous, you might say. Less voluminous because he knows how to find the right words, and now I'm working on it a lot. So it's less explosive than at the very beginning of our relationship. It's all about working on yourself. And... For him, it would be more his intransigent side. I'm able to soften him, to make him realize that sometimes he exaggerates and that other people don't always have those intentions. And that if he doesn't use gentler language, he's bound to miss the point. And that's exactly what makes him softer. In a way, in his choice of words. Which is astonishing, because we're gentle with each other, but not in the same way. In a way, it encompasses us.

Speaker 1: And in connection with that, do you feel you're the same person you were before the relationship? Has the relationship changed you in the end?

Speaker 2: I think the relationship has changed me, but in the end, it's not so much a change as it reveals more of our personality. Basically, it puts more emphasis on things we already had, but maybe never managed to fully express. But there you have it. I don't think you can change someone profoundly. You are what you are, but there are things you can make less of or more of.

Speaker 1: Would you say that these things have had a positive or negative impact on you?

Speaker 2: Personally, positive, towards others, mixed, it's a combination. Because when you change, the people around you become aware of the change and this can have a more or less positive or negative impact on the relationships you had with these people.

Speaker 1: And on your boyfriend's side, do you feel he's changed on his side? Or that he's stayed the same throughout the relationship?

Speaker 2: No, he hasn't stayed the same, he's changed. But... I think it's all for the good. So it's cool. So yes, I'd say so. That it's evolved in certain ways.

Speaker 1: Are these the aspects you were talking about earlier with your question of calming each other down, or is there something else involved as well?

Speaker 2: I think there are other things. For example, there are things we take from each other about the way we organize ourselves, there are things we take from each other about the way we do things that we might never have done otherwise. In the end, we say to ourselves, I prefer your way of doing things to mine. So we totally change our way of doing things.

Speaker 1: I think the conversation is going to close soon. I don't know if we'll come back right away or if I'll wait the full 15 minutes.

Speaker 2: It's up to you.

Speaker 1: I suggest we switch right away so we're not cut off in the middle of a sentence.

Speaker 2: Right. With the same link?

Speaker 1 : Normally, yes, but if not, I'll e-mail you another right away.

Speaker 2 : Okay, no problem.

Speaker 1: Great. Is it all good?

Speaker 2: Yes.

Speaker 1: Next, I wanted to ask you, do you feel secure in your relationship?

Speaker 2: Yes.

Speaker 1: What does safety mean to you?

Speaker 2: For me, a couple is a bit... It's physical security, emotional security, sexual security, all those aspects. I feel confident. For me, security and trust are linked.

Speaker 1: The question of safety can also mean do you feel you can open up to your partner without fear of judgment or reprisal? And also, if you're in distress, can you get comfort or attention from him or her? Are these things you find in your relationship?

Speaker 2: Yes.

Speaker 1: That's what you told me, so you feel you're in a safe relationship in general.

Speaker 2: Yes. It's very rare that I can't say things without thinking that something's going to happen. It's not a feeling that dominates or that...

Speaker 1: Are there times when you've felt this safety question more than others? Or is it more something that's there in the end?

Speaker 2: No, it's just... It's there, actually. It's there and from time to time, we feel safer, but if it's less, it's not necessarily insecurity.

Speaker 1: And now I'd like to talk about another dimension that can be important in a couple's relationship: sexuality. For you, is it a dimension that's important in your relationship, not too important, how important?

Speaker 2: I have an in-between point of view. I would have said at the beginning, our relationship for me, it wasn't the most important thing. I think it's important, and it's not in... I think it depends on what we define as sexuality, but it's not essential either.

Speaker 1: Important but not essential. You told me it depends on what you put in sexuality. What do you mean by that?

Speaker 2: It depends. Do you mean sexual relations in the strict sense of the word, and going all the way, or do you include tenderness and cuddly moments in sexuality? It depends on how you look at it. If sexuality is all-encompassing, then yes, it's important in our relationship. I'm sorry, but it wouldn't be possible not to cuddle. Softness, tenderness, all those gestures. But if someone told me that you absolutely have to have sex every week to have a stable relationship, I'd say... pfff. I'm not saying you shouldn't have sex, but... It's not... No, but it's... In my opinion, it wouldn't be absolutely essential to have that frequency, that regularity.

Speaker 1: Yes, so it becomes indispensable if you understand the whole aspect of tenderness, everyday affection and everything that goes into it, right?

Speaker 2: Yes, that's it.

Speaker 1: And currently, how often do you have sex with your boyfriend?

Speaker 2: Literally cyclical. Sweat (?), all the time... Literally cyclical, I'm not kidding! It's literally cyclical. It's extremely dependent on my period. Literally, in other words, there's a moment when you're going to do it a lot, and then afterwards, there'll be nothing for [1-5] weeks.

Speaker 1: Okay.

Speaker 2: To give a really caricatured image, that is to say, there will be periods when you're really fine, you feel like it, and all that, and then there will be times when we look at each other, we go "do you feel like it?" "No, you?", "no", well okay. It's really... We agree, it's the desert, yeah. It's complete chaos on that level. But yes, it would be... Once a month, you know. That's for sure.

Speaker 1: And are you satisfied with your sex life?

Speaker 2: Yes. I have nothing to complain about there.

Speaker 1 : So, we're going to move on now... I'll show you some scaled. I'm going to ask you to answer some questions. I'm going to ask you to answer some questions. We're done with the more interview part. So, I'm going to share my screen. I just need to make sure I'm in the right place. So, can you see my screen?

Speaker 2: So, it's loading. Yes.

Speaker 1 : Can you see the scale on the display?

Speaker 2: Yes, I see.

Speaker 1: So, to the question... Well, yes. Usually, my partner really listens to me. What would you say is between not at all true, moderately true, completely true, everything in between?

Speaker 2: I'd say 8.

Speaker 1: Why?

Speaker 2: I think he usually listens to me. But would I say that's completely true? I think it depends when we discuss things again and sometimes we don't understand each other. I think... There are things you hear unintentionally that you don't listen to. So I wouldn't give it a 9 for that reason.

Speaker 1: Right. How about 7, then?

Speaker 2: Because I still think, despite everything, that he really listens to me and takes... Well, that's not just very true. It's a little more than completely true. But a little less about less. It's very complicated to explain how I gauge things in my head, but... It's in between for me, really.

Speaker 1: Can you give us an example of a time when you felt really listened to?

Speaker 2: Um... When I wasn't feeling well, like I had once, I was really, really not feeling well, and I felt that he was listening and really understanding, even though he wasn't necessarily going through the same thing, that he didn't necessarily understand 100%, that he wasn't in my shoes. I felt a deep interest in what I was telling him. He was really trying, he was asking me questions, he was really trying to understand what I was explaining to him.

Speaker 1: And if I asked you, this time, is my partner generally attentive to my needs, what would you put between not at all true, completely true?

Speaker 2: Um... I'd say 9.

Speaker 1: 9? Yes, so why 9?

Speaker 2: Because he generally listens to my needs. It's not all the time, but generally, the number fits me well.

Speaker 1: Why not 8?

Speaker 2: Um... Because for me, there's no question of... of... of... in-between. It's really, he listens to my needs, he knows my needs, and he's attentive to them, generally.

Speaker 1: So, same question as before, was there a moment when you felt he was... I mean, when you really felt that he was listening to your needs?

Speaker 2: Um... That's what I was talking about this morning, when I'm not feeling well, when I'm having my period, that he anticipates, that he knows it's going to be a more or less complicated period for me, and that... I mean, he feels, but sometimes, the needs I have before myself, before I'm aware of them. So, I think that, yeah, we can be completely true without... without exaggerating at all.

Speaker 1: Okay, I see. And how satisfied are you with your relationship? Completely dissatisfied, very dissatisfied, well, everything up to completely satisfied?

Speaker 2: I'm completely satisfied.

Speaker 1: And, um... So, I'm just finding the right scale. Oh no, that's fine. I'll just cut that out for now. So, why would you say you're completely satisfied?

Speaker 2: Um... Because I wouldn't change my relationship for anything in the world, for both its qualities and its faults. So, if I had to choose these qualities, these faults, in the person I'm with, I'd choose them without hesitation, because I love them for both. And that's... That's what makes our relationship what it is.

Speaker 1: And... Yes, that's right, so completely satisfied. Very satisfied, for you, it wouldn't be the same thing, would it ?

Speaker 2: Well, there's the average thing about saying it's satisfying. For me, on the satisfying side, we're really, well, it's fine, but it's not great, about the relationship. I mean, it's just the way it is. It's not bad. They say it's very satisfying. For me, there's a bit well, it's a little better than average, but well, there you go. But there's also the completely satisfied side, which is... I mean... It's not perfect, but that's precisely why the relationship is good. It's not just linear, anyway, a relationship, it's the whole that's good.

Speaker 1: So, I'm going to present you with one last scale. If you had to give a numerical value to your degree of satisfaction, what would you put yourself in?

Speaker 2 : Isn't that the same question as before?

Speaker 1: Uh... So...

Speaker 2 : I don't see the difference between the two.

Speaker 1: Yes, that's normal. So, we had questions about listening, and then we had satisfaction, but with words, adjectives. And here, it's more if you had to give a number, really.

Speaker 2: Ah, right. That's why I thought, what's the difference?

Speaker 1: No, I understand.

Speaker 2: Uh... Well, I'm completely satisfied. I'm staying on the same... The same score.

Speaker 1: So it would be a 10 here?

Speaker 2: Yes, that would be a 10.

Speaker 1: So, we're about to conclude this part. Before that, I'm going to give you a link to a questionnaire. So, I'll stay with you while you fill it out, in case you have any questions. But before I send you the link, is there anything else you'd like to add to what we've discussed so far?

Speaker 2: Um... Um... I don't think so. It's got me asking myself questions I don't even think about asking. The whys and the abouts, it's not something. Sometimes, it's...

Speaker 1: Yes, actually, there are things we're not used to thinking about.

Speaker 2: Yes, that's how it is. But otherwise, no, nothing.

Speaker 1: Okay. So, I'm going to send you the link to the questionnaire. I'll cut the recording on my side.